

The Hierarchy of the Primus Deus Fidelis:

Saint Primus

(The Original Saint, he is the nominal ruler of Celestia, and, supposed "First Among Equals" of the Saints. In reality, his power and influence is much reduced.)

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The Conclave of Saints (this needs work)

(This is a loose confederation of mortals who ascended to sainthood through mostly mysterious ways. Although nominally subservient to Saint Primus, ruler of Celestia, the Saints vary in power and influence. They are reputed to be organized into a Conclave (much like the earthly church) which acts as an advisory council to Saint Primus.

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Angels (this needs work)

These are the servants of Celestia, and the native beings of that plane of existence.

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The Scion of Saint Primus

Referred to as The Scion, this is the hereditary descendant of Saint Primus, and self-styled absolute ruler of the church and the empire. In centuries past, his power may have been absolute, but in the present, his reach is much reduced. As with Saint Primus, The Scion is dependent on the Conclave for much of his power. However, his position, wealth, knowledge and family history have allowed him to maintain his pre-eminence among the various Canons of the faith.

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The Prelates of The Saintly Canons & The Great Conclave

(Referred to as "The Prelates", these individuals are the supreme leaders of each individual Saintly Canon. The Saintly Canon is the set of laws, philosophies, rules and overall teachings of a particular saint. It also refers to the entire hierarchical organization of priests, clerics, monks and knights in service of that saint. The Prelates lead the clergy, monasteries, knightly orders and divine societies in service of their individual saint, wherever they may be located in the world. Additionally, and perhaps most importantly, they gather together in the Cathedral of Saint Primus in Avitus to form the Great Conclave. the Great conclave itself was once the ruling body of the empire as well as s of the faith. Since the revolution, it has lost its authority over the empire's secular government. It has also become more fractious with individual Prelates and groups of Prelates consumed with in-fighting and personal agendas.

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The Holy Deans, Priors and Abbots of The Saints

(The senior-most ranks within individual cathedrals, societies, monasteries and knightly orders, "Fathers" and "Masters" lead the regional interests of each Saint's Canon. Deans preside over great cathedrals and the attached provinces, as well as the societies of clerics. Priors command from the fortresses and castles of their knightly orders. Abbots preside over their monasteries and schools.)

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The Priests, Clerics, Knights and Monks of The Saints

(The priests, clerics, knights, and monks of the saints, referred to simply as "Brothers" comprise the bulk of the hierarchy of the church. Priests lead individual parish churches, or maintain shrines throughout the land. They are the single most common individual within the church. Clerics are the special chosen few of each Saint, who have been granted the rare and powerful abilities of spell-casting and other powers. They typically form into Societies to further the goals and divine wishes of their patron saints. The knightly paladins are the backbone of

the military wing of the church, though they are few and far between in civilized lands. The monks of the saints live cloistered in monasteries, both within cities and in remote areas. They also maintain great schools and scriptoriums where they further the education of humanity.)

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The Canonical Initiates

(The initiates of the faith, referred to as "Initiates", are the individuals training and aspiring to the higher ranks within the church hierarchy. Whether training for the priesthood, aspiring to knighthood, devoted to a monastic rule, or chosen by a Saint for a society of clerics, initiates come in all shapes, sizes, ages and genders.)

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The Wardens of the Faith

(Those lay-individuals not called into spiritual service within the church, but who have sought employment or have associated themselves with the church regardless, are called "Wardens". they come from all walks of life, serving as clerks, cooks, servants, scribes, assistants, administrators and so on.)